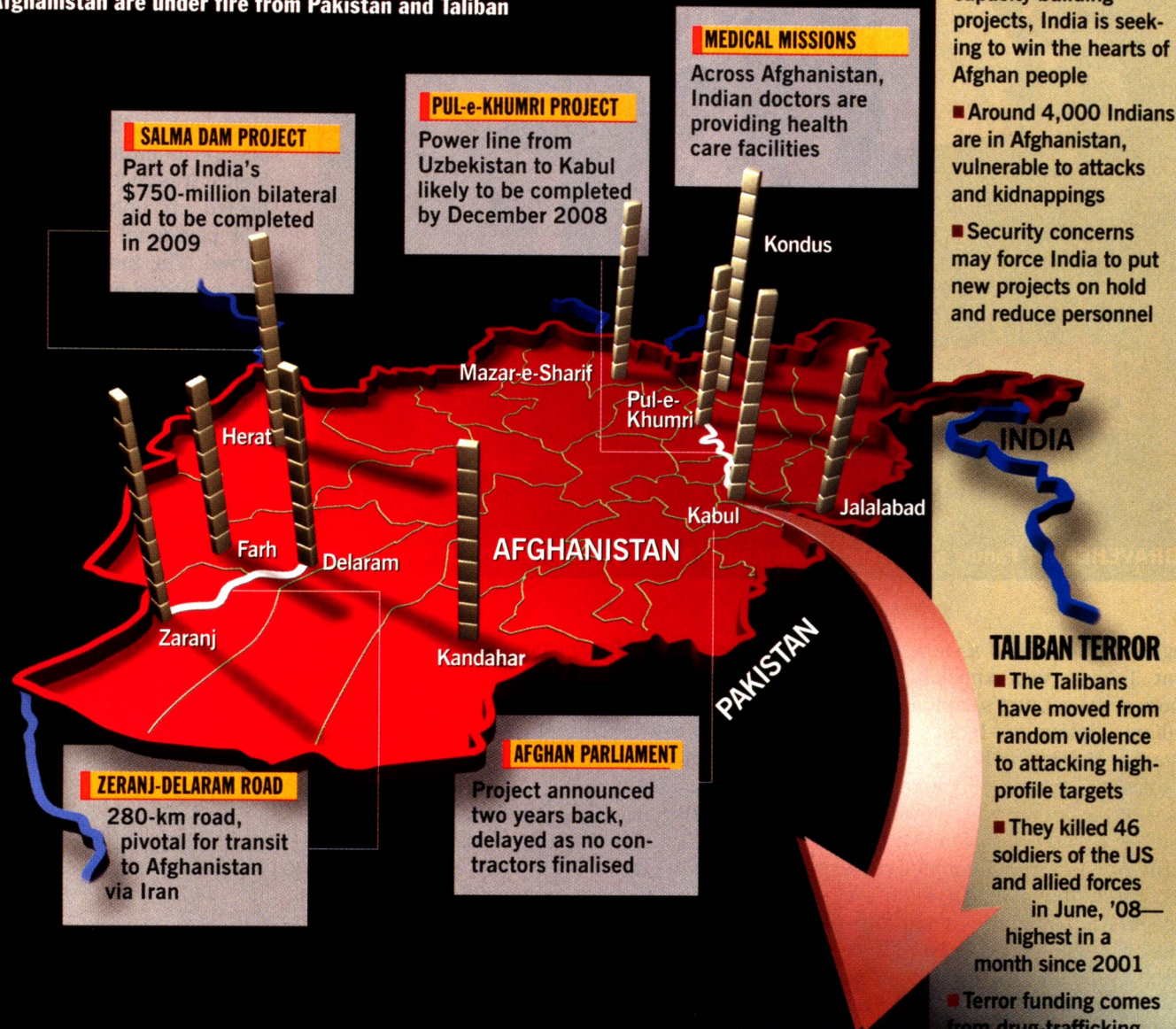


THE STAKES IN KABUL

India's growing influence and strategic depth in Afghanistan are under fire from Pakistan and Taliban



INDIA'S INROADS

- Through a series of reconstruction and capacity building projects, India is seeking to win the hearts of Afghan people
- Around 4,000 Indians are in Afghanistan, vulnerable to attacks and kidnappings
- Security concerns may force India to put new projects on hold and reduce personnel

TALIBAN TERROR

- The Taliban have moved from random violence to attacking high-profile targets
- They killed 46 soldiers of the US and allied forces in June, '08—highest in a month since 2001
- Terror funding comes from drug-trafficking and kidnapping. Earns \$300 million per year, from 10 per cent tax on opium cultivation.

WHAT REALLY HAPPENED

Suicide attack on Indian mission was a well-planned exercise

- The car bomber tries to enter the mission by tailing an embassy car
- Alert ITBP guards delay opening of the gate. The bomber panics and detonates at the gate.
- The Toyota Corolla car was packed with 80 kg of RDX and had land mines and tank shells



Graphic by PRASHANT CHAUDHARY